



Africa

Covering almost 20 percent of Earth's total land area, Africa is the second-largest and the second most populous continent. It is also the hottest continent—the world's largest desert, the Sahara, is located here. Africa is home to the African elephant and the giraffe, the world's biggest and tallest animals, respectively. *Homo sapiens* (modern humans) are thought to have evolved in Africa and then spread out across the world.

▲ NAMIB DESERT
Visitors climb to the summit of a sand dune in the Namib Naukluft National Park, Namibia. The burnt orange dunes found here are the tallest sand dunes in the world.